

In the Name of the Most High
Statement of the Center for Interreligious and Inter-Cultural Dialogue
Of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization
On the occasion of World Interfaith Harmony Week

The Center for Interreligious and Inter-Cultural Dialogue of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization of the Islamic Republic of Iran avails this opportunity to commemorate the World Interfaith Harmony Week (First Week of February), which was proclaimed by a United Nations General Assembly resolution in the year 2010. Keeping in view their positive consequences for the human society, this Center would always welcome such occasions.

The Week coincides with the auspicious Daheye Fajr or the Decade of Dawn (January 31 to February 11) - which mark the anniversary of the victory of the Islamic Revolution of Iran as the greatest religious development in the contemporary history of human societies; a revolution that revived the monotheistic values and the life-giving ideas of freedom and defending the oppressed people of the world.

Imam Khomeini (ra), the Great Founding Leader of the Islamic Revolution, referred to the presence of the followers of different religions in the Islamic Republic of Iran as a divine opportunity and blessing, and Grand Ayatollah Khamenei, the Supreme Leader of the Islamic Revolution, has always emphasized peaceful coexistence of the followers of different religions and considers dialogue among religious thinkers and scholars to be a useful and praiseworthy move; especially when it results in adopting a common stand with regards to the most vital issues in human life.

Undoubtedly, man's salvation in both the worlds has been and is the main goal of all religions. Peaceful coexistence between the followers of different religions and peoples of different cultures as well as the strengthening of altruism is necessary for the well-being of human societies. If we were to imagine human societies as one human being, he is a being who is quite lonely, afflicted, pain-stricken, and needy, and if it were not for divine care, he would only be doomed to damnation and destruction.

Unfortunately, human societies continue to suffer from tyranny, racism, poverty and hunger, insults to religious sanctities, greed on the part of fellow human beings, and many other maladies. And the disastrous spread of the "Covid 19" pandemic, which has exacerbated the existing sufferings, has provided a clear and comprehensive picture of the existing maladies.

While commemorating World Interfaith Harmony Week, the Interreligious and Inter-Cultural Dialogue of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization of the Islamic Republic of Iran would like to reminisce the global mission of religious leaders, intellectuals, and scholars of the world in promoting friendship and empathy between the followers of religions and strengthening the discourse of religious dialogues and also request the just and fair elites of the world to take a clear stand against open hostility towards the divine religions and the spread of religio-phobia. We also call on international institutions to enact laws to prevent disrespect for the sanctities of religions and to preserve the dignity of all religious believers.

We pray to God Almighty that the existing countless human sufferings will be reduced to a great extent, solidarity will rise among the followers of religions, the spirit of brotherhood among the children of Adam would deepen, and effective steps will be taken towards the achievement of the objectives of these occasions and the expansion of peace and justice in the world, such that we can witness the reduction of the sufferings of the contemporary man.

Center for Interreligious and Inter-Cultural Dialogue

Islamic Culture and Relations Organization

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